

REFERENCE CARD

Technical secondary and vocational orientation

What has worked, in the region and outside it, for the two axes the viceministra named. Each case in two sentences: how it works, and what it delivered.



§ 01 ·

WHY THIS CARD

On 30 August, viceministra de Gestión Pedagógica **Miriam Ponce** published the sector's working agenda: update the curriculum, **strengthen technical secondary**, align CETPRO and institutes with productive demand, and **reinforce vocational orientation** and the COAR. This card carries the evidence for the two axes where the Bank can offer something concrete this week.

§ 02 ·

VOCATIONAL ORIENTATION: THE CHEAP LEVER

Peru, MineduLAB: Decidiendo para un Futuro Mejor. Cómo funciona: the ministry's own innovation lab, with IPA, showed short videos on the real returns to finishing school, inside class hours, right before students decide. **Impacto:** lower dropout at a marginal cost of **S/ 0,20 per student**, with the potential to keep more than 25,000 students in school, and better ECE mathematics scores in Junín and Áncash. **This ministry already proved the idea;** the AI career coach is the same idea, ten years on.

Dominican Republic (Jensen, QJE 2010). Cómo funciona: students dramatically underestimated what finishing school pays; the trial simply told them the measured returns. **Impacto:** more completed years of schooling from information alone. The founding result behind every returns-information programme since.

Mexico, returns information in upper secondary (Avitabile and de Hoyos). Cómo funciona: a randomised trial gave students facts on returns and on how to finance further study. **Impacto:** mathematics learning rose by about a tenth of a standard deviation: students who see why school pays work harder at it.

§ 03 ·

TECHNICAL SECONDARY: THE DESIGNS THAT DELIVERED

Korea, Meister high schools. Cómo funciona: 52 technical schools designed with industry inside: firms co-write the curriculum, practitioners teach, and hiring agreements are part of the model. **Impacto:** graduate employment above **90% in 2013 to 2017**, and still the top of the system: 73,1% employed against 52,4% for specialised schools and 38,2% for vocational tracks in general schools, with the best one-year job retention (71,5%).

Switzerland and Germany, the dual system. Cómo funciona: students split the week between classroom and a paid apprenticeship in a firm, across 250 occupations; the firm is a co-educator, not a destination. **Impacto:** two thirds of Swiss young people choose this route, and Switzerland holds one of the lowest youth unemployment rates in the OECD. The lesson that travels is the design, not the wealth.

Mexico, CONALEP's dual model. Cómo funciona: the German design adapted to a middle-income system since 2013: alternance between school and firm under formal agreements between colleges and companies. **Impacto:** dual-track students show **better grades, attendance, completion and university admission** than the traditional track. Proof the dual idea survives translation to Latin America.

Colombia, Jóvenes en Acción (Attanasio, Kugler and Meghir). Cómo funciona: for the CETPRO axis: three months of classroom technical training plus three months of in-firm practice, delivered by private providers paid for placement. **Impacto:** a randomised trial found higher formal employment and earnings, around **20% for women**, with effects persisting years later.

§ 04 ·

WHAT THE BANK CAN PUT ON THE TABLE THIS WEEK

A **comparative technical note** on Meister, the dual system and CONALEP, with a design for a Peruvian technical-secondary or COAR pilot. A **revival of the MineduLAB orientation line**, now with AI, through the career coach already running in 110 schools. And a **working session with the viceministra's teams** to choose the entry point, which is exactly the technical meeting the mission asks for.

SOURCES

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2. Meister high schools, IDB Education blog, and labour-market gaps, Cogent Education 2023 · <https://www.iadb.org/en/blog/education/meister-high-schools-south-korean-model-revitalize-technical-and-vocational-education>
3. CONALEP, *La experiencia en la Formación Dual* · https://www.gob.mx/cms/uploads/attachment/file/291188/La_experiencia_del_CONALEP_en_la_Formacion_Dual_VF_.pdf
4. Swiss VET, OECD country study · https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/vocational-education-and-training-systems-in-nine-countries_1a86eb6c-en/full-report/vocational-education-and-training-in-switzerland_051e4a43.html
5. Jensen 2010 QJE; Avitabile and de Hoyos; Attanasio, Kugler and Meghir · literature, full citations on request